

haven't been any major activities in the past which directly damaged property or lives using electronic methods. What strengthens the argument is the claim by most researchers and companies that the computer systems and networks of today are safe enough to counter widespread denial of service on everyday activities.

The possibilities

While the narrow definition of cyber-terrorism is not wrong given that any widespread disruption in services hasn't been encountered, possibilities still linger. A simple look around would reveal the chances. Let's consider a day-to-day life of an imaginary middle-class person named Yash. Later using the same example, we'll show you how dependent we've become on computing systems.

1. It's 5:30 a.m. and Yash's alarm on his mobile phone goes off. He slides the icon on his smartphone to turn it off and wakes up.
2. After freshening up, he grabs his laptop to check for any important email from the office or messages from friends. He doesn't find anything significant; only routine email from his work colleagues. Regular stuff. All is well.
3. Yash showers, dresses and leaves for work on his bike at 9:25 a.m. He reaches office in 45 minutes at 10:10 a.m. Thanks to the extra traffic and red signals at the most inopportune of moments, he's late. Not much of a problem; he escaped a telling off since even his boss is late!



Though not terrorism, BJP party site defaced by Anonymous as part of a co-ordinated attack